About this Book

In this book I hope to show you how to use the data you're already generating to make your teams, processes, and products better. The goal of the book is to teach your agile team which metrics it can use to objectively measure performance. You'll learn what data really counts, along with where to find it, how to get it, and how to analyze it. Because meaningful data may be gathered or used by any part of an agile team, you'll learn how all team members can publish their own metrics through dashboards and radiators, taking charge of communicating performance and individual accountability. Along the way, I hope you'll pick up practical data analysis techniques, including a few emerging Big Data practices.

Roadmap

This book is broken into three parts: "Measuring agile performance," "Collecting and analyzing your team's data," and "Applying metrics to your teams, processes, and software."

The first part introduces the concepts of data-driven agile teams: how to measure your processes and how to apply it to your team. Chapter 2 is an extended case study that takes the concepts from the first chapter and shows them in action on a fictional team.

The second part of this book is made up of four chapters, each focusing on a specific type of data, how to use it on your team, and what that data tells you by itself. We start off with project tracking system (PTS) data in chapter 3, move on to source control management (SCM) data in chapter 4, explore data from continuous integration (CI) and deployment systems in chapter 5, and finally in chapter 6 look at data you can get from application performance monitoring (APM) tools. Each chapter in this section ends in a case study that shows you how the data and metrics from the chapter can be applied to your team from the team's point of view.